

Week 1 Learner Self-Assessment

Learner details

Field	Response
Full name	Nompilo Eugenia Mchunu
Cohort or intake	Cloud to Solutions Accelerator, July 2026 cohort
Date completed	20 August 2026

Skills baseline

The rating scale is 1 for no experience, 2 for basic awareness, 3 for some practical exposure, 4 for being able to complete common tasks, and 5 for being comfortable working independently.

Skill area	Rating	Context
Cloud computing concepts	3	I understand Regions, Availability Zones, service models, resilience, and the reasons organisations move workloads to the cloud.
AWS console and services	3	I have worked through AWS learning activities and can explain where EC2, Lambda, ECS, S3, RDS, and related services fit.
Python programming	3	I can work with variables, functions, conditionals, collections, files, and small data-processing scripts.
SQL and databases	4	I can design related tables and write filtering, JOIN, grouping, aggregate, and HAVING queries in MySQL.
Git and GitHub	3	I understand the add, commit, push, and weekly portfolio workflow and can organise work into clear repository folders.
Linux and command line	2	I can navigate files and run common commands but still need more practice with administration and shell tooling.
Networking basics	3	I understand IP addressing, DNS, routing, subnets, security groups, and the purpose of a multi-tier VPC.
Solutions architecture	3	I can compare AWS services, document trade-offs, and draw an architecture that responds to business requirements.

Career direction

My primary target role is Solutions Architect. The role appeals to me because it combines technical knowledge with business problem-solving. I want to become confident at turning requirements such as

data residency, low latency, resilience, and cost control into clear AWS designs that I can explain and defend.

Programme goals

Where I want to be in 12 months

I want to have earned the AWS Solutions Architect Associate certification and be ready to apply for an entry-level cloud or solutions architecture role. I also want this portfolio to show that I can do more than describe AWS services: I can use SQL and Python, document decisions, and connect each component to a real business requirement.

My ideal capstone project

My ideal capstone is a complete FinTrust transaction intelligence architecture. It should accept transactions securely, score them for fraud in near real time, store data with appropriate controls, support reporting, and remain available during infrastructure failures. I want the final design to include clear diagrams, security boundaries, recovery objectives, and reasons for every major service choice.

My biggest concern entering the programme

My main concern is keeping up with the number of services and understanding when to choose one service over another. I plan to manage this by keeping concise decision notes, practising scenario questions, and using the FinTrust requirements to connect each new service to a practical use case.